

Nikhil: Unanswered Enquiries

The Founder

Nikhil Deshpande, Founder of Aangan Studio, Pune. Interior design for homes and small offices. 60 people, 14 designers.

The Situation

Aangan's work sells itself - referrals and Instagram bring a steady stream of enquiries. The problem is what happens to them.

Enquiries arrive across multiple channels - the studio phone, WhatsApp, and a form on the website. The front desk is two people covering 10am to 7pm. A third of enquiries arrive outside those hours.

Nikhil pulled his own numbers last month and found something that has been bothering him since: an enquiry answered within an hour converts at four times the rate of one answered the next day. Roughly half of all enquiries get no response within 48 hours.

When an enquiry does reach a designer, it usually arrives as a forwarded message with no context. The designer's first call is spent asking questions the front desk already asked.

The Numbers

- ~200 enquiries/month
- ~48% get no response within 48 hrs
- Answered <1 hr: 4× conversion vs. next-day
- ~33% arrive outside 10am–7pm
- Front desk: 2 people
- Average project value: ₹8–14 lakh

The Ask - in his words

"Every enquiry must get answered in five minutes, day or night. The ones worth my designers' time should reach them with everything already asked. And the system should be able to quote our standard per-square-foot pricing so people don't have to wait for that."

Scope of the Build

You are building for **incoming phone calls only**. Aangan receives enquiries across three channels but the phone is where the volume and the urgency are highest. WhatsApp and the web form are out of

scope for this build - you will note how your solution could extend to them, but you will not build those channels.

What you have access to

enquiries/ — 40 real enquiry transcripts, anonymised, across all three channels

services.md — what the studio does and doesn't do

pricing.md — internal pricing guide, with the note "indicative only, varies by site"

qualified.md — Nikhil's own description of which enquiries are worth a designer's time

Your Role

You are in Nikhil's founder's office. He has asked you to own this. He will ask you why.

You will also decide how the handoff note reaches a designer - Telegram or email. You have worked with both. Be ready to justify the choice.

You will also show him what the system costs to run and what it is generating. Nikhil pulled his numbers manually last month. The dashboard you build should mean he never has to do that again - including the cost of the tool doing it for him.

Before You Come to Class on 7 Oct

Read this brief carefully. Using it as your source material, prepare the following and complete them before coming to class:

1. **Automation Brief:** Write down the 'Why' - Pain, User, Outcome - and map The Journey Today.
 2. **Nine Checks:** Work through all nine checks with evidence from the case. Identify the Cut: the one thing Arjun has described wanting that a check stops you from building.
 3. **Components Map:** Map the workflow using the Trigger → Input → Context → Processing → AI → Output structure from your session notes
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